

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Subject Description Form

Subject Code	ITC508
Subject Title	Current Issues in Fashion Business
Credit Value	3
Level	5
Pre-requisite / Co-requisite/ Exclusion	Nil
Objectives	This subject identifies topical matters influencing, or potentially about to influence the design, production, sourcing, distribution and marketing of apparel fabrics and fashion collections. Through analysis of current business activities of relevance to the fashion industry and exploration of prediction models which may assist in managerial decision making, students will be sensitised to the global trading environment. In addition, their problem-solving skills will be enhanced.
Intended Learning Outcomes	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: 1. Identify, communicate and apply new knowledge of relevance to the operation of the fashion enterprise. 2. Independently and competently select and/or design and apply prediction models to facilitate industry operations. 3. Enhance and broaden their international outlook. 4. Refine their problem-solving skills. 5. Further develop inter-personal and teamwork abilities.
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus	1. <u>Lifestyle Developments</u> Sporting activities and cultural events; political, social and economic issues influencing selected populations; applicability of trends to manpower recruitment and training programmes, fashion trend prediction, retailing strategies and the determination of fashion collection characteristics. 2. <u>Ecological Issues</u> Factors affecting the protection of the environment and consequences for the selection of garment production sites, sourcing of materials, re-engineering and recycling of products, and related promotional issues of relevance to corporate image.

	3. <u>Legal Issues</u> International laws governing trade agreements, counterfeiting and the protection of intellectual property, contractual issues for sourcing and supplying garments, transshipment of goods, ethical practice in the garment industry. 4. <u>Image Management</u> Coordination of graphic, industrial, interior, fashion and other branches of design for the products and services of the garment enterprise; the visual identity of the brand in the marketplace and related visual/intangible issues. 5. <u>Media Planning and Public Relations</u> Dissemination of information and media contacts; selection of advertising channels and organisation of publicity events; assessing the success of the advertising campaign, generating interest in new collections through promotional activities.																																																						
Teaching/Learning Methodology	The subject comprises lectures, seminars, case problem solving and group discussions. Guest speakers will be invited to elaborate on specialist subject areas.																																																						
Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes	<table><tr><th rowspan="2">Specific assessment methods/tasks</th><th rowspan="2">% weighting</th><th colspan="5">Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed</th></tr><tr><th>1</th><th>2</th><th>3</th><th>4</th><th>5</th></tr><tr><td>1. Coursework</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td> a) Presentation at seminar</td><td>15%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td></tr><tr><td> b) Class test</td><td>10%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td></td></tr><tr><td> c) Mini project</td><td>25%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td></tr><tr><td>2. Examination</td><td>50%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>Total</td><td>100%</td><td colspan="5"></td></tr></table> The problem-solving tasks for the presentation encompass all subject learning outcomes in both the preparation and presentation of findings. The class test serves to assess the cognitive aspects of subject matter and likewise the final examination. By working on a case solution, in groups with varying degrees of ‘macro’ and ‘micro’ information inherent in the process of formulating and presenting reports the students will once again achieve all learning outcomes and have criteria-referenced feedback for further consideration in their professional lives.	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed					1	2	3	4	5	1. Coursework							a) Presentation at seminar	15%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	b) Class test	10%	✓	✓	✓	✓		c) Mini project	25%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	2. Examination	50%	✓	✓	✓	✓		Total	100%					
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Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:	
	▪ Lecture	28 Hrs.
	▪ Tutorial	11 Hrs.
	▪ Self-study	66 Hrs.
	Total student study effort	105 Hrs.
Reading List and References	<u>Selected References:</u> Guercini, S. & Runfola, A. Business networks and retail internationalization: A case analysis in the fashion industry. <i>Industrial Marketing Management</i>, 39, 2010, pp. 908-916, downloadable at http://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S0019850110000921 Bhardwaj, V. & Fairhurst, A. Fast fashion: Response to changes in the fashion industry. <i>The International Review of Retail, Distribution & Consumer Research</i>, Vol. 20, No. 1, 2010, pp. 165-173, downloadable at http://www.tandfonline.com/doi/pdf/10.1080/09593960903498300 Watchravesringkan, K., Nelson Hodges, N., & Kim, Y-H. Exploring consumers' adoption of highly technological fashion products: The role of extrinsic and intrinsic motivational factors. <i>Journal of Fashion Marketing & Management</i>, Vol. 14, Iss. 2, 2010, pp. 363-281, downloadable at http://www.emeraldinsight.com/journals.htm?articleid=1858875&show=abstract Aziz, A. RMG trading scenario in India and other major countries – comparative performance and issues. <i>International Journal of Business & Management</i>, Vol. 6, No. 6, June 2011, pp. 267-275, downloadable at http://www.ccsenet.org/journal/index.php/ijbm/article/viewFile/10849/7701 Castelli, C.M. & Brun, A. Alignment of retail channels in the fashion supply chain: An empirical study of Italian fashion retailers. <i>International Journal of Retail & Distribution Management</i>, Vol. 38, No. 1, 2010, pp. 24-44, downloadable at http://www.emeraldinsight.com/journals.htm?articleid=1837595&show=abstract Surchi, M. The temporary store: a new marketing tool for fashion brands. <i>Journal of Fashion Marketing and Management</i>, Vol. 15 Iss: 2, 2011, pp.257 – 270, downloadable at http://www.emeraldinsight.com/journals.htm?articleid=1926554&show=abstract Wang, W.Y.C. & Chan, H.K. Virtual organization for supply chain integration: two cases in the textile and fashion retailing industry. <i>International Journal of Production Economics</i>, Vol. 127, Iss. 2, Oct. 2010, pp. 333-342, http://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S0925527309002862	

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	Black, S. & Eckert, C.M. Developing considerate design: Meeting individual fashion and clothing needs within a framework of sustainability. In Pillar, F.T. & Tseng, M.M. (eds.), Handbook of Research in Mass Customization and Personalization, Vol. 2, World Scientific, 2010, pp. 813-832, available in HK PolyU Library, call number TS155.65.W67.2007 Armstrong, C.M. & LeHew, M.L.A. Sustainable apparel product development: In search of a new dominant social paradigm for the field using sustainable approaches. Fashion Practice – The Journal of Design, Creative Process and the Fashion Industry, Vol. 3, No. 1, May 2011, pp. 29-62 Waters, Y.V. Stakeholder expectations for environmental performance within the apparel industry. MSc thesis, University of Delaware, 2010, 228-page pdf file downloadable at http://dspace.udel.edu:8080/dspace/bitstream/handle/19716/5842/Yazbehl_Waters_Thesis.pdf?sequence=1 Niinimäki, K. Eco-clothing, consumer identity and ideology. Sustainable Development, Vol. 18, Iss. 3, May-June 2010, pp. 150-162, downloadable via HK PolyU Library at http://web.ebscohost.com/ehost/pdfviewer/pdfviewer?vid=3&hid=21&sid=a19c1122-4ef7-4099-92b6-7eea15066550%40sessionmgr11 Hiller Connell, K.Y. Exploring consumers' perceptions of eco-conscious apparel acquisition behaviors. Social Responsibility Journal, Vol. 17, Iss. 1, 2011, pp. 61-73 Marcelo, C. Honors Thesis, Liberty University, USA - The Crimes of Fashion: The Effects of Trademark and Copyright Infringement in the Fashion Industry. 2011, downloadable in pdf format, 30-page document, at http://digitalcommons.liberty.edu/cgi/viewcontent.cgi?article=1254&context=honors Ellis, S. R., Copyrighting couture: An examination of fashion design protection and why the DPPA and IDPPPA are a step towards the solution to counterfeit chic. Tennessee Law Review, Vol. 78, 2010, pp. 163-212. Available at SSRN: http://ssrn.com/abstract=1735745 Beltrametti, S. Evaluation of the Design Piracy Prohibition Act: Is the cure worse than the disease? An analogy with counterfeiting and a comparison with the protection available in the European Community. NJTIP Vol. 8, Iss. 2, Spring 2010, available in html format at http://www.law.northwestern.edu/journals/njitip/v8/n2/1/ Monseau, S. European design rights: A model for the protection of all designers from piracy. American Business Law Journal, Vol. 48, Iss. 1, Spring 2011, pp. 27-76, downloadable at http://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/10.1111/j.1744-1714.2010.01111.x/pdf
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